Ding-Han (Sean) Yan

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University Recruiting Team
Stripe
354 Oyster Point Boulevard, South San Francisco, CA

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Application for Software Engineer, Intern

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Software Engineer Intern position at Stripe. I am a fourth-year Honours Computer Science student at UBC, and I am drawn to Stripe for a simple reason: your customers depend on you for their livelihoods, and I want to build software where being rigorous actually matters. Maintaining some of the most reliable APIs on the internet is the kind of engineering I want to learn from.

I have already shipped production work end to end. During my eight-month internship at MetaGuru, I architected an AI agent in Python, Celery, and Redis that automated meeting documentation across WeChat, LINE, and REST APIs, saving my team 5 to 7 hours every week, with async jobs running on AWS Lambda, EC2, and S3. I also built LDAP single sign-on middleware in C# and .NET, deployed with Docker, K3s, and Nginx. Outside work, I built a serverless finance API with API Gateway, Lambda, and SQS, decoupling writes through a queue and defining every resource as code, and a Node.js and Express API backed by more than 45 automated tests. Writing tested, reviewable code is a habit, not an afterthought.

What I do best is learn unfamiliar systems quickly. When the Model Context Protocol had just launched, my team needed to understand it and its limits while the AI community was full of hype. I researched it, separated signal from noise, taught the team its core ideas, and wrote the documentation they still use today. I use AI tools every day, but I also build them, which has taught me exactly where their output needs a careful human review. I work in Java and JavaScript already, and I am confident I can pick up Ruby, Go, and Scala the same way.

I also care about clear communication. As a teaching assistant for CPSC 121, I explain logic and computation to first-year students, and a video I made about how I learn and take notes reached over 20K views on YouTube. Explaining my work clearly to teammates and stakeholders comes naturally to me.

What my resume cannot show is that I am a people person. I bring good energy and a strong work ethic, and I care about the details others skip: I run a homelab secured behind a VPN, and I have written dozens of scripts to remove small frictions from my development workflow, because I believe good infrastructure makes everyone faster.

I would love to bring this mix of rigor, curiosity, and drive to Stripe. Thank you for your time and consideration; I would welcome the chance to discuss how I can contribute to your team.

Sincerely,

Ding-Han (Sean) Yan